

role, providing supplies to guerilla fighters as well as fighting themselves. Muthoni wa Kirima even had the rank of field-marshal bestowed on her.

In Tanganyika (now Tanzania), women played a formidable role in the success of the political party Tanganyika African National Union (TANU)

founded in 1954; its women's wing Umoja wa Wanawake wa Tanzania, headed by Bibi Titi Mohamed, united and mobilized women in the independence struggle. Mohamed, who later became minister for women and social affairs, was also involved in the *ngoma* (dance groups) in Tanzania. These women's groups became clandestine vehicles for nationalist mobilization, announcing TANU protests, and raising party funds. Mohamed attributes her political successes to these dance groups, which she sees as providing a chance to practice leadership and make connections within women's networks.

In Ghana, revolutionary leader Kwame Nkrumah relied on women during the fight for independence and afterward. After meeting with him in 1947, Hannah Kudjoe became a major independence activist, single-handedly mobilizing rallies across the country. Following independence, she founded the All-African Women's League, which later became the Ghana Women's League. She is one of many women who played key roles in anti-colonial struggles across the world, who have not been fully credited for the extent and value of their fight.



BIOGRAPHY

ARUNA ASAF ALI

Born in Punjab in 1909, Aruna Asaf Ali was educated at a Catholic school but later married Muslim lawyer and anti-colonialist Asaf Ali. She became involved in the fight for independence, and in 1942 hoisted the Congress flag in Bombay, inaugurating the Quit India Movement. She then went into hiding for four years but still edited the Congress Party's magazine. After independence, she joined the Congress Socialist Party and became secretary of the Delhi Women's League. She died in 1996 and won India's highest civilian award, the Bharat Ratna, a year later.

